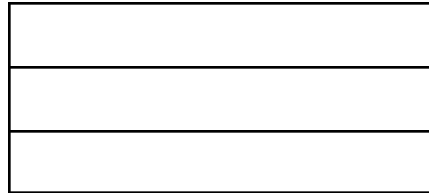
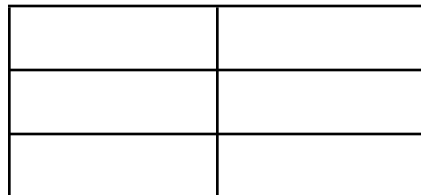


Instructions for a tetra-tetra-flexagon

1. Take a rectangular or square sheet of paper (can be any size) and fold it in thirds like this (the thirds don't have to be equal):



2. Fold the paper in half the other way:



3. Fold the right and left edges into the middle, so that you have creases like so:

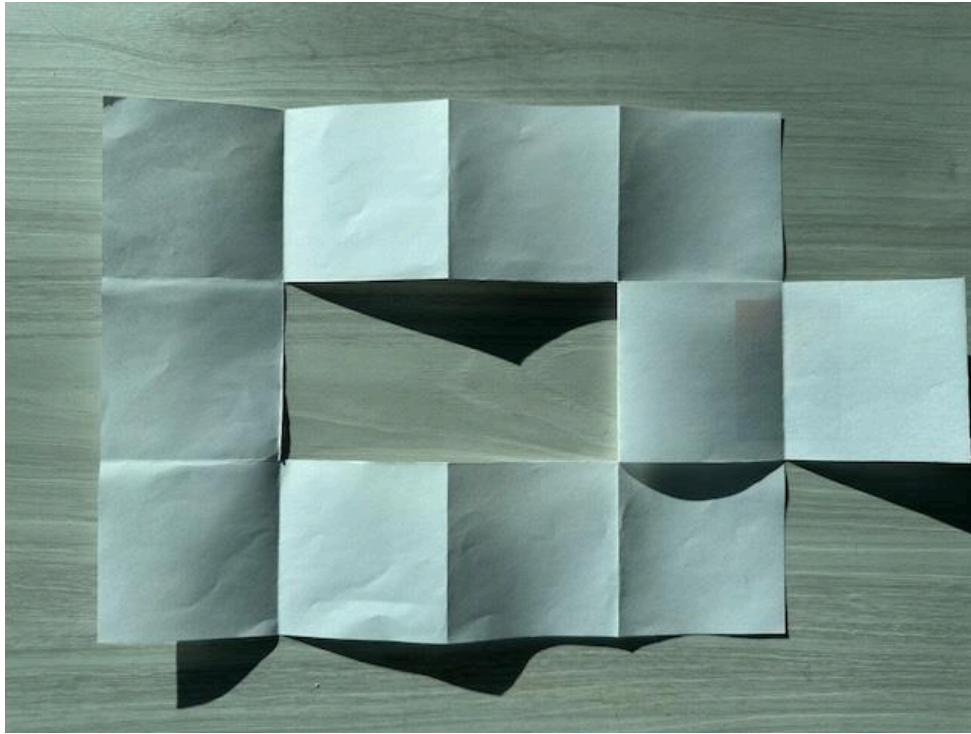
1	2	3	4
1	2	3	4
1	2	3	4

4. Crease all the folds in both directions, so that the paper can bend flexibly.

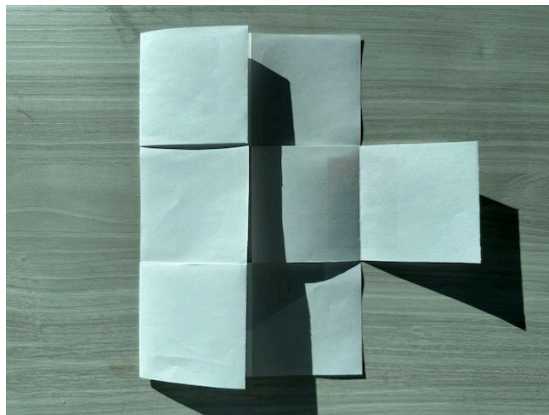
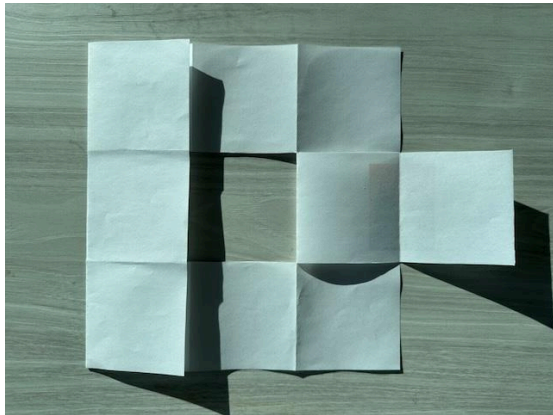
5. Cut along the dotted lines to turn the two interior squares into a flap:

1	2	3	4
1	flap		4
1	2	3	4

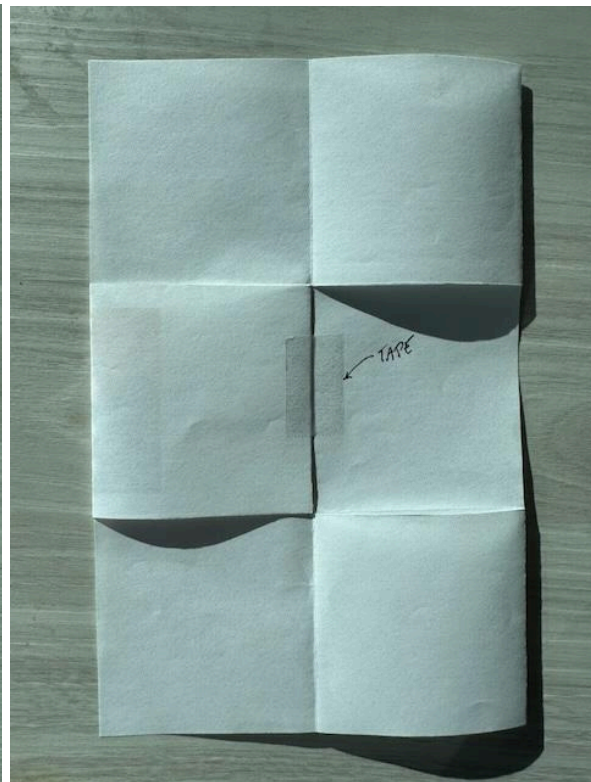
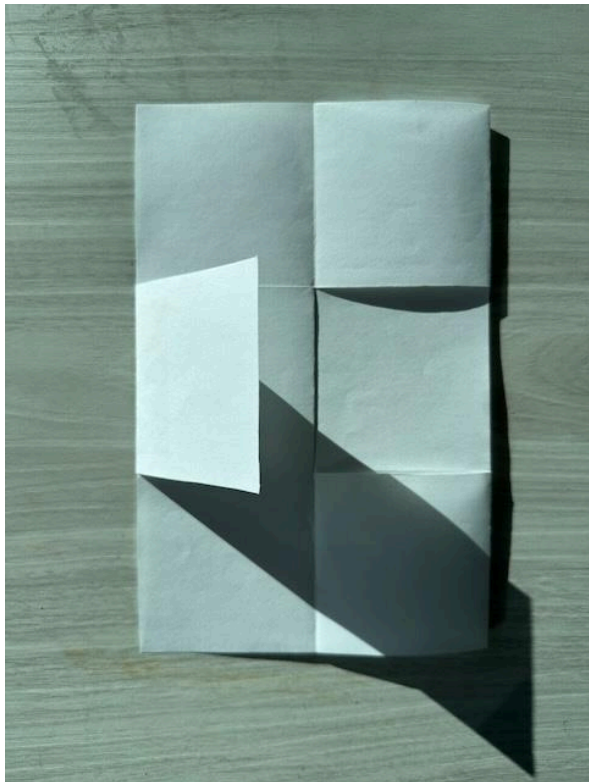
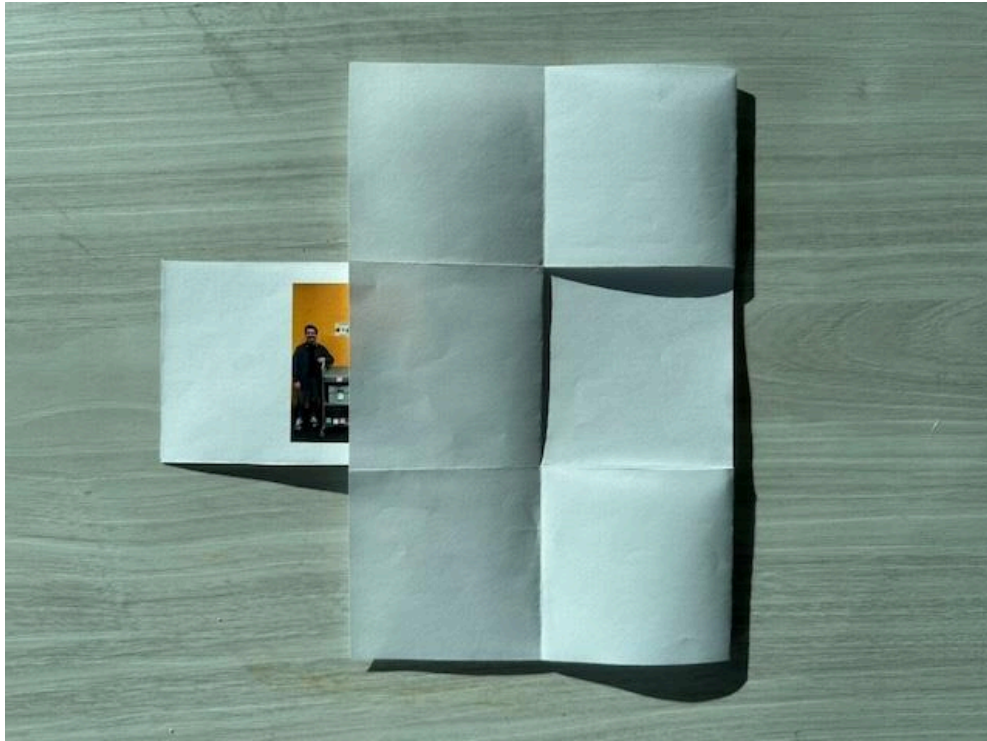
6. Fold the flap to the right (covering column 4), so that the two interior squares are open.



7. Fold column 1 inward, and then fold columns 1 and 2 inward to cover column 3.



8. Turn the whole assembly over, and fold the outer square of the flap inward. With tape or a small paper tab, secure the right-hand edge of the flap to the neighboring edge to the middle square of the right-hand column. You're done!



About the tetra-tetra-flexagon

You can flex this form by folding the two halves away from you and pulling the central seam gently apart. After several flexes, you'll come to a dead end and can flex back the way you came.

Those dead ends can be places of discovery—for instance, you can embed small pop-up structures or tiny pamphlets inside them.

Although the “columns” in this flexagon must be the same width, you can experiment with different heights for the “rows” when you do the initial fold into thirds.

This form suggests interesting possibilities:

- for parallel narratives
- for journeys out and back
- for symmetry and mirroring

You could also experiment with more complex versions that have five rows and two flaps (or seven rows and three flaps!)—you might need to use heavier paper for these.